

FOOTBALL KNOW THE RULES

The Laws of the Game — made simple for Years 5 & 6

1 THE MATCH AT A GLANCE


11
PLAYERS A SIDE


90
MINUTES LONG


2
HALVES OF 45


1
BALL, 2 GOALS


3
MATCH OFFICIALS

2 THE BIG RULES


OFFSIDE
You must have **two opponents** (usually the keeper + a defender) between you and the goal line when a team-mate passes to you. Stand behind the last defender — **if you're level, you're onside.**


HANDBALL
No touching the ball with your **hand or arm** — on purpose, or by making your body bigger. Only the **goalkeeper** can handle it, and only inside their own penalty area.


CARDS
The referee shows cards for unfair play.
Yellow = warning **Red = you're off!**


FOULS
No **tripping, pushing, kicking, holding** or dangerous tackles. The other team gets a **free kick** — or a **penalty** if the foul happened in the box.


BALL OUT OF PLAY — HOW IT RESTARTS
Over the side line? Throw-in (both hands, over your head, both feet on the ground). • **Over the goal line off an attacker?** Goal kick. • **Over the goal line off a defender?** Corner kick. • **Whole ball must cross the whole line** — on the line is still in!

3 YOUR GAME IS DIFFERENT!

UNDER 11 FOOTBALL
The FA's rules for Years 5 & 6

9
V 9 PLAYERS

30
MIN HALVES

4
SIZE OF BALL

0
LEAGUE TABLES

4 THE UNWRITTEN RULES

NOBODY WRITES THESE DOWN...
...but every real footballer follows them. This is what makes you a player people want on their team.

 Kick the ball out if an opponent is injured.

 Shake hands with every opponent at the end.

 Clap your keeper when they make a mistake, not just a save.

 Give it straight back to them at the throw-in.

 Never argue with the referee — they decide, you play.

 Don't over-celebrate against a team you're thrashing.